



GOVERNANCE DOCUMENT

Continuing Professional Development (CPD) Policy

International Society of Equity Analysts

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This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.

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1. Purpose

The International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) is committed to ensuring that equity analysts and investment professionals maintain and continuously enhance the knowledge, skills, professional competence, and ethical standards required to perform their roles effectively.

This Continuing Professional Development (CPD) Policy establishes the framework through which ISEA members, certificants, and professional designation holders undertake ongoing learning and development activities throughout their careers.

ISEA recognises that the equity analysis profession is continuously evolving due to changes in financial markets, valuation methodologies, technology, regulation, artificial intelligence, sustainability considerations, and investor expectations. Continuous professional development is therefore essential to maintaining public confidence in the profession.

This Policy supports ISEA's commitment to professional excellence and operates consistently with the **Ethics Policy** and the **Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct**, and internationally recognised standards for professional organisations.

2. Scope and Application

This Policy applies to:

- Members (Student Members, Associate Members, Members and Fellows)
- Holders of ISEA professional certifications and designations;
- Individuals participating in ISEA-recognised professional development programs; and
- Governance Council members, committee members, officers and representatives where professional development requirements apply.

The Governing Council may determine mandatory CPD requirements for specific membership categories, certifications, or professional designations.

3. Objectives of CPD

The objectives of ISEA's CPD framework are to:

- Maintain and enhance professional competence;
- Promote lifelong learning among equity analysts;
- Ensure members remain current with industry developments;
- Encourage ethical and responsible professional practice;
- Support the adoption of emerging technologies and analytical methods;
- Strengthen confidence in the equity analysis profession.

4. CPD Principles

ISEA's CPD framework is based on the following principles:

4.1 Professional Responsibility

Members are responsible for maintaining their own competence and ensuring that their knowledge and skills remain relevant.

4.2 Relevance

CPD activities should contribute meaningfully to professional capability in areas relevant to equity analysis, investment research, financial markets, or related disciplines.

4.3 Flexibility

ISEA recognises that professionals have different career paths and learning requirements. The CPD framework allows flexibility while maintaining appropriate standards.

4.4 Quality

CPD activities should be undertaken through credible, structured, and professionally relevant learning experiences.

4.5 Integrity

Members must accurately record and represent their CPD activities and must not submit false or misleading information.

5. CPD Requirements

5.1 Annual Requirement

Unless otherwise determined by the Governing Council, ISEA professional Members and certification holders shall complete a minimum of:

25 hours of qualifying CPD activity per calendar year.

The remaining CPD activities shall be relevant to the Member's professional responsibilities, professional development or areas of practice.

The Governing Council may establish different requirements for specific certifications or membership categories having regard to:

- Professional designation requirements;
- Regulatory expectations;
- Industry standards; and
- International benchmarking.

Activities undertaken as a normal and routine part of a Member's employment or professional responsibilities shall not ordinarily qualify as CPD. However, structured training, formal education and other substantive professional development undertaken in connection with employment may qualify where the activity contributes meaningfully to the Member's professional knowledge, skills or competence.

5.2 Ethics Requirement

As part of the annual CPD requirement, members should complete a minimum of **two (2) hours** per year dedicated education relating to:

- Ethics;
- Professional Standards;
- Research principles;
- Research integrity;
- Conflicts of interest;
- Market conduct; or
- Professional responsibilities.

The 2-hour ethics requirement forms part of the 25 hours annual requirement prescribed in clause 5.1 and is not additional to it.

The Governing Council may prescribe a different minimum hours requirement for ethics-related activities having regard to the requirements of particular professional designations or certifications, regulatory expectations, industry standards, international benchmarking, and the evolving ethical requirements of the equity research profession.

5.3 Certification-Specific Requirements

Certain ISEA certifications may impose additional CPD obligations.

Certification holders must comply with:

- Certification-specific requirements;
- Renewal conditions;
- Competency maintenance requirements.

Failure to satisfy certification CPD requirements may affect certification status.

6. Qualifying CPD Activities

6.1 General Principles

Qualifying CPD activities may involve the acquisition, development, application or sharing of professional knowledge and skills, provided the activity contributes meaningfully to the Member's professional competence, knowledge or capabilities.

A qualifying activity may be undertaken independently or through participation in, attendance at, preparation for or delivery of a relevant professional development activity.

ISEA may determine reasonable limits or conditions for particular categories of CPD activity to ensure that CPD claimed by Members represents substantive and relevant professional development.

ISEA recognises a broad range of qualifying CPD activities, including:

6.2 Formal Education

Examples include:

- University courses;
- Professional qualifications;
- Industry training programs;
- Technical workshops;
- Specialist courses;
- Postgraduate study;
- Professional examinations and examination preparation;
- Accredited or structured online courses.

6.3 Conferences and Events

Examples include:

- ISEA conferences;
- Professional seminars;
- Industry forums;
- Investment research events;
- Academic conferences;
- Investor and analyst conferences;
- Issuer, industry or specialist briefings;
- Professional roundtables and forums.

6.4 Technical and Professional Training

Examples include:

- Equity valuation training;
- Financial modelling;
- Accounting analysis;
- Financial statement analysis;
- Data analytics;

- Programming and quantitative methods;
- Artificial intelligence and machine-learning applications;
- Alternative data analysis;
- ESG and sustainability analysis;
- Portfolio management;
- Risk management;
- Econometrics and statistical methods;
- Research methodology;
- Financial markets and economic analysis;
- Regulatory and compliance training;
- Ethics and professional standards.

6.5 Research and Publication

Examples include:

- Publishing professional research;
- Conducting substantive research projects;
- Writing analytical articles;
- Preparing educational materials;
- Developing research methodologies or analytical frameworks;
- Presenting investment research;
- Preparing substantive investment or industry studies;
- Authoring or contributing to professional publications

6.6 Teaching and Mentoring

Examples include:

- Delivering professional education;
- Mentoring analysts or other finance professionals;
- Teaching finance-related courses;
- Conducting professional workshops;
- Delivering lectures or presentations;
- Developing and delivering training programs;
- Participating as a faculty member, instructor or subject-matter expert.

6.7 Self-Directed Learning

Examples include:

- Reading professional publications;
- Reviewing research papers;
- Studying technical materials;
- Reviewing financial statements and industry materials for professional development;
- Completing approved online learning activities;
- Studying regulatory, professional or academic publications;
- Structured study of emerging technologies and analytical methodologies.

ISEA may establish reasonable limitations on self-directed learning hours.

7. CPD Subject Areas

CPD activities may include, but are not limited to:

7.1 Technical Knowledge

Including:

- Equity valuation;
- Financial statement analysis;
- Accounting standards and financial reporting;
- Financial modelling;
- Quantitative methods;
- Econometrics and statistical analysis;
- Investment research methodologies;
- Portfolio analysis;
- Risk analysis and management;
- Corporate finance;
- Fixed income and credit analysis;
- Derivatives and other financial instruments;
- Alternative valuation methodologies.

7.2 Industry and Market Knowledge

Including:

- Sector and industry analysis;
- Economic developments;
- Capital markets;
- Financial market structure;
- Investment trends;
- Macroeconomic analysis;
- Geopolitical developments affecting markets;
- Regulatory and legislative developments;
- Corporate governance;
- Sustainability and ESG developments;
- Emerging investment themes.

7.3 Professional Skills

Including:

- Professional communication;
- Report writing;
- Presentation and public speaking;
- Interviewing and information gathering;
- Corporate access and management engagement;
- Leadership;
- Research management;
- Teamwork and collaboration;
- Time and project management;
- Client and stakeholder communication.

7.4 Technology and Innovation

Including:

- Artificial intelligence;
- Machine learning;
- Data analytics;
- Programming and coding;
- Research automation;
- Alternative data;
- Financial databases and analytical platforms;
- Digital investment tools;
- Data governance and quality;
- Technology risk and limitations;
- Emerging research technologies.

7.5 Ethics and Professional Standards

Including:

- ISEA Code of Ethics and Standards of Professional Conduct;
- Research independence and objectivity;
- Conflicts of interest;
- Market integrity;
- Confidentiality and material non-public information;
- Fair dealing;
- Professional misconduct;
- Plagiarism and intellectual integrity;
- Disclosure requirements;
- Ethical use of technology and artificial intelligence.

8. CPD Records and Documentation

Members are responsible for maintaining accurate records of completed CPD activities.

Records should include:

- Activity title;
- Provider or organisation;
- Date completed;
- Duration;
- Subject area;
- Evidence of completion where available.

ISEA may request supporting documentation, including:

- Certificates;
- Attendance confirmations;
- Completion records;
- Publication evidence.

9. CPD Reporting and Monitoring

ISEA may require members to:

- Submit annual CPD declarations;
- Confirm compliance with requirements;
- Provide evidence upon request.

ISEA may conduct periodic reviews or audits to verify CPD compliance.

10. CPD Accreditation and Providers

ISEA may recognise or accredit CPD providers that demonstrate appropriate standards of:

- Technical quality;
- Educational relevance;
- Professional integrity;
- Transparency.

ISEA may establish criteria for approved CPD providers.

11. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with CPD requirements may result in:

- Notification of non-compliance;
- Requirement to complete remedial education;
- Suspension of certification benefits;
- Suspension or removal of professional designation;
- Membership disciplinary action.

Before imposing significant consequences, ISEA shall provide the individual with an opportunity to respond.

12. CPD Exemptions and Extensions

ISEA may grant exemptions, reductions, or extensions where appropriate, including circumstances involving:

- Extended illness or incapacity;
- Parental responsibilities;
- Career transition;
- Exceptional personal circumstances;
- Other approved reasons.

Requests must be submitted in accordance with ISEA procedures.

13. Responsibilities

13.1 Members

Members are responsible for:

- Maintaining professional competence;
- Completing required CPD activities;
- Keeping accurate records;
- Acting honestly in CPD reporting.

13.2 Education & Certification Committee

The Education & Certification Committee shall:

- Develop CPD frameworks;
- Recommend CPD requirements;
- Review CPD quality standards;
- Monitor effectiveness of CPD programs.

13.3 Ethics & Professional Standards Committee

The Ethics & Professional Standards Committee shall:

- Address ethical issues arising from CPD compliance;
- Review deliberate misrepresentation of CPD records;
- Recommend disciplinary action where appropriate.

14. Technology and Artificial Intelligence Considerations

ISEA recognises that technology and artificial intelligence are transforming equity research.

Accordingly, ISEA encourages members to develop appropriate capability in:

- AI-assisted research;
- Data analysis;
- Technology-enabled investment workflows;
- Digital research platforms.

Members remain responsible for ensuring that technology is used ethically, accurately, and with appropriate professional judgment.

15. Review and Continuous Improvement

The Education & Certification Committee shall periodically review this CPD Policy to ensure alignment with:

- Industry developments;
- International professional standards;
- Regulatory expectations;
- Member needs;
- Technological advancement.

Recommendations for amendment shall be submitted to the Governing Council for approval.

16. Effective Date

This Continuing Professional Development Policy takes effect on the date approved by the Governing Council.